

BEFORE YOU QUOTE

Why good tattoo inquiries go quiet after the price - and what to change before your next quote.

INQUIRY > CLARITY > ESTIMATE > DECISION

THE QUOTE IS ONE MOMENT.

The client experience starts before it.

THE QUOTE IS NOT ALWAYS THE PROBLEM.

Some clients simply cannot afford the project, are not ready, or are not a fit. That is normal.

But sometimes a suitable client disappears because the conversation reached price before the project - or the next decision - was clear.

WHAT YOU SEE

- They liked my work.
- They seemed serious.
- I sent the number.
- Then they went quiet.

WHAT MAY BE MISSING

- A defined tattoo project
- Enough context to estimate
- A specific next decision
- A follow-up path if timing changes

BEFORE YOU LOWER YOUR PRICE, CHECK:

WHAT HAPPENED BEFORE YOU SENT IT?

If the project was clear, the estimate was appropriate, and the next step was obvious, the answer may simply be no. The goal is clarity - not forcing every inquiry into a booking.

STOP ASKING

**"WILL THIS PERSON
CHOOSE ME?"**

START ASKING

**"ARE WE A GOOD FIT
FOR EACH OTHER AND
FOR THIS PROJECT?"**

That changes what you do next.

- You gather the information needed to understand the tattoo.
- You do not spend the same time on every inquiry.
- You present the estimate as part of a defined project.
- You know what happens if the answer is yes, not now, or no.

Your next level won't happen in a price argument.

You know the conversation.

“How much?”

You give a number.

They ask for less.

Now you're defending years of practice to someone who hasn't asked a single question about your work.

An Instagram message can be the first introduction. But when your whole booking experience stays in that thread, it's easy for the conversation to become a comparison of prices.

The client sees a number. You see the drawing, the planning, the execution—and everything it took to become capable of doing it.

Haggling won't close that gap.

The clients who invest in substantial custom work need reasons to feel confident choosing you. Your portfolio matters. So does the experience of dealing with you. A scattered exchange of prices and concessions does little to establish that confidence.

If you want clients to treat your work as a serious investment, your booking experience needs to reflect that.

That was one of the biggest changes in my own career: moving client intake out of DMs and giving it a system.

If you want to see some examples of what has worked for me, The Booked Artist System was built to help you make that shift in your own business.

You can't negotiate someone into being the right client.

Someone can love tattoos and still be the wrong fit for your work.

They might want a different style. Have different priorities. Need a price you can't sustainably offer. None of that changes because you spend another evening trying to convince them.

But when you need the booking, it's hard to let go.

You explain more. Offer more. Cut the price. Start imagining a version of the project that makes everybody happy, except you.

I know that feeling. I've taken work because the money was there, even when it pulled me away from the career I wanted.

You CAN'T make someone value what you value.

You CAN decide how much of your time and energy you keep investing in that mismatch.

A smaller tattoo can be a great booking. A large tattoo can be a terrible one. Fit depends on your work, your goals, and whether the project makes sense for both people.

The Booked Artist System gives that change in perspective something practical to anchor to. Something you can adapt to your own situation as you become more deliberate about the work you take on.

You don't need every inquiry to become your client.

You need your bookings to move you toward the career you're trying to build.

Give the career you want a place in the decisions you make today.

Maybe your calendar has too many gaps.

Maybe it's full of \$200 and \$300 tattoos while the larger pieces you want to create stay in your sketchbook.

Either way, you can feel the distance between what you're capable of and what tattooing is giving you back.

I spent years improving my drawings and designs. But the biggest level up in my career came when I changed how I handled client intake and where I put my time and energy.

It felt crazy to turn down a tattoo when I could use the money. It took time to stop stepping over dollars to pick up dimes.

I also know what it feels like to be sought out for my work, make thousands in a day, and have happy clients give me more than I asked.

I don't know if I'd still have a tattoo career, much less a successful one, without making this shift.

The Booked Artist System is the practical support I built around it.

Its templates and guides give you guardrails you can customize around your work, your clients, and your goals. You bring the artistic ability and the ambition. The system helps you put intention behind the business they're building.

Start with the Working System — \$47

My recommended edition for most artists ready to build toward better bookings and more rewarding work.

GET THE BOOKED ARTIST SYSTEM →

One payment. 30-day satisfaction guarantee.

— **Joker Ink**

18 years tattooing · Studio owner

[@jokerinkx3](#)

STOP LETTING GOOD PROJECTS DIE IN YOUR DMs.

The sleeve that went quiet. The project buried in messages. Put a process behind the inquiries you're already getting.

RECOMMENDED

Working System / \$47

13 numbered tools + guides. Handle inquiries, changing project details, client pauses, and deposit confirmation with a process you can actually follow.

Original PNGs, numbered PDFs, a combined workbook, and setup guides. The order is already on the pages.

GET WORKING SYSTEM / \$47

One payment. Individual artist license. 30-day satisfaction guarantee.

Other editions: Essentials / 6 tools / \$27. Complete System / 22 tools / \$77. Each higher edition includes everything below it.

@jokerinkx3 | tatassist.com/lp/booked-artist